Q. Who is the No. 1 hero in the country?



2 SHAH RUKH KHAN **24.5** [27.6]



4 AKSHAY KUMAR **7.7** [8.6]



3 SALMAN KHAN **7.9** [8.9]



5 ALLU ARJUN **6** [5.4]

Q. Who is the No. 1 heroine in the country?



2 KATRINA KAIF **10.3** [11.%]



4 RASHMIKA MANDANNA **7** [7.2]



3 ALIA BHATT **9.4** [9.6]



5 ANUSHKA SHARMA **6.8** [6.3]

All figures in %; rest, others; Aug. '24 figures in bold, Feb. '24 in [ ]



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1 DEEPIKA PADUKONE **24.7** [23.8]



1 PANKAJ TRIPATHI **19.2** [17.8]

Q. Who is India's No. 1 male OTT star?



2 MANOJ BAJPAYEE **13.4** [13]



3 ABHISHEK BACHCHAN **13.1** [13.6]



4 BOBBY DEOL **8.9** [12.1]



5 NAWAZUDDIN SIDDIQUI **7.2** [9.1]

Q. Who is India's No. 1 female OTT star?

1 SUSHMITA SEN **13.2** [14.3]





2 RAVEENA TANDON **11.9** [10]



3 RADHIKA APTE **11** [11.5]



4 KAJOL **9.9** [11.4]



5 POOJA BHATT **7.8** [9.7]

At 81, US president Joe Biden may have called it a day after over five decades in politics, but Amitabh 'the GOAT' Bachchan is still duelling with men half his age on screen. In doing so, he is not only winning hearts but also keeping the box office counters ringing with movies like *Kalki 2898 AD*. Whether it be his long hosting stint at *Kaun Banega Crorepati*, marked by an admirable balance of curiosity, charm and gravitas, or his stream of meticulously numbered tweets, Bachchan is delivering a masterclass in how to keep your cinematic career going. In doing so, he has also reclaimed the throne he had relinquished earlier this year to Shah Rukh Khan, who had a fabulous 2023, courtesy two back-to-back blockbusters. After a hiatus this year, Shah Rukh will next be seen in *King*, a home production in which he will share the screen with his daughter, Suhana Khan.

The latest India Today Mood of the Nation poll also indicates that both Bachchan and Shah Rukh are in a league of their own when it comes to being darlings of the masses. It explains the wide gap between them and the rest of the field which features Salman Khan and Akshay Kumar, with the latter par-